

Life Lessons from Working Within the Corporate Dream (Part 2) – Metallicman

 metallicman.com/laoban4site/life-lessons-from-working-within-the-corporate-dream-part-2

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August 13, 2018



This is part 2, it is a continuation of part 1.

You know, many of us work for a living. As such, if you have a university degree, the chances are that you migrated to a corporate job in a corporate environment. You probably received a decent salary, a nice (if bland and sterile) working environment, and considered yourself well on the way towards corporate greatness in a solid career.

It's a nice fantasy. It's all a big lie.

Most Americans waste their lives working in this environment. They get up and go to work. They deal with traffic, an uncaring boss, and suffer through the various rules that HR implements. They endure mindless and mind-numbing meetings, answer a pile of round-and-round email trains, and fill out form after form.

That's not a life worth living.

A life worth living is one with purpose, direction, participation and fulfillment. Within the now-popular "corporate model" we have the worst elements of 1920's-style progressive social-engineering intermixed with 1980's-austerity. It is a most horrible mixture. Couple

that with modern surveillance technology, unified HR standards, and the sterile ideal, you have a nightmare.

Here are some thoughts on corporate life, particularly American corporate life, now that I moved on elsewhere. These thoughts are just general ramblings, and the reader should not get too offended by them. We are all different.

Those of you who own your own companies and who set them up can ignore this post. This is not written for you. This is written precisely for the people who have to work in the “corporate” environment. One that often springs up out of the model you created.

This is a Two-Part Post

This is the second of a two part post. To see the first part, please kindly go [HERE](#).

The 360 Review

Sometime a decade or so ago, the reincarnation of [Beelzebub](#) came up with the idea of a HR technique known as a “[360 Review](#)“. This is a review of a employee where the employee is presented with all their good and bad together in a yearly review. It is based on the false premise that saying negative things about a person, to their face, will result in positive outcomes.



A Dilbert take on the 360 Review process.

Eventually this policy will fade away into obscurity. Companies that implement this policy tend to have short turnover cycles.

Trust me, no one wants to sit by while people tell them bad things about their life, their work, their dress, their behaviors, and aspects of their personality. In fact, a real MAN should get up, say that they will not tolerate such disrespect and leave.

Imagine sitting down and telling Clint Eastwood all of his bad faults and things that you don't like about him...



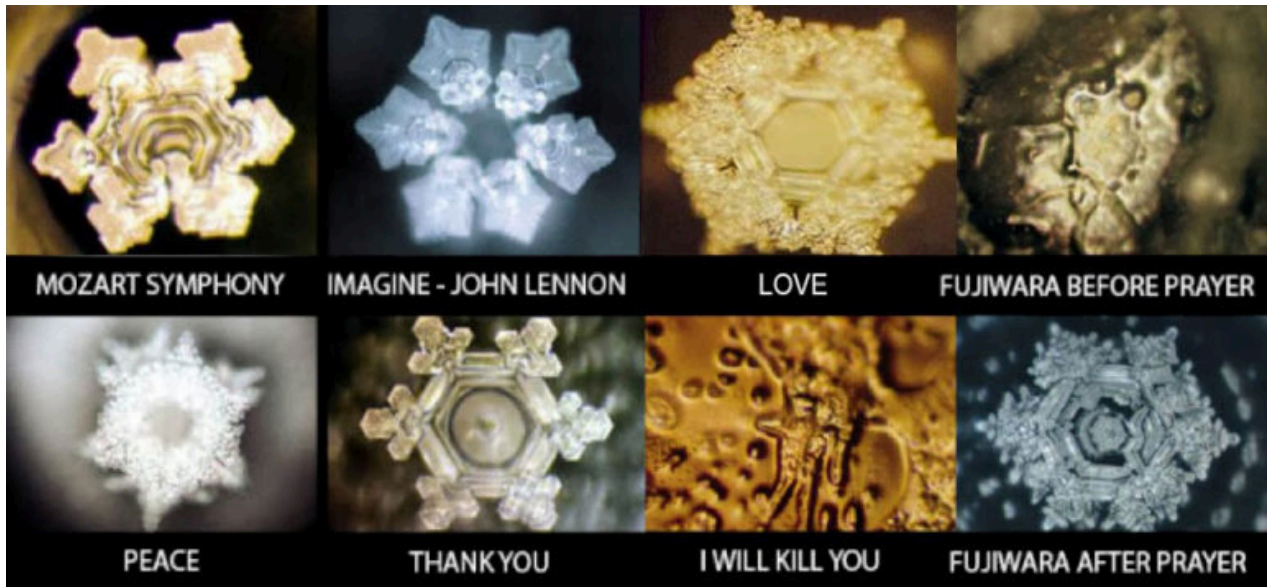
I don't think that either the actor Clint Eastwood, nor any of the characters that he played in his many movies, would stand for the verbal abuse of a 360 review. It is abuse. Do not think otherwise.

Thoughts affect our reality.

Now, the old saying "*Sticks and stones might break my bones, but words will never hurt me*", is quite outdated. It is based on a Newtonian understanding of how the universe works. In the Newtonian reality, all that exists is what you observe. Things and objects follow predictable relationships with other physical things. There is nothing outside of the physical world. Well, surprise! The universe does not obey a Newtonian reality. It obeys a *quantum* reality.

That's a wake up call for all you statisticians out there in internet-land.

In the quantum world, we now have a revised saying; "*Sticks and stones will break my bones, and words will hurt me even more.*"



Dr. Masaru conducted a very famous test on the power of thought. He placed written words on jars of rice in water. He then placed them all together in an isolated room. The only difference from any of the jars is the words written on the jars. He then, after a period of time, tested the water, froze it, and took photographs of the results. The jars with the negative and hurtful words created the worst shaped crystals, while those with the nicest words had the best shaped crystals. The only difference between the crystals are the thoughts associated with the words on the jars. Since humans are mostly composed of water, what do you think a critical work environment would do to the human body?

In the corporate world you have a false reality that you have to exist within. You obey it, and you take the uncomfortable all for a paycheck. It doesn't have nor need to be that way. So don't accept it.

Don't accept it. Just do not.

If need be, imagine your favorite television character and put on that "face" and role. Because, for what ever it is worth, this kind of behavior done in China is considered the height of "face loss". It just isn't done here. So imagine your favorite character, and take on their persona when dealing with this kind of nonsense.

[via GIPHY](#)

[21] The corporate world is a fantasy. It is a fake reality that is designed to subjugate the worker into behavioral norms that benefit the corporation. There is often no concern to the needs of the worker.

Responsibility with no Authority

Very often, in the corporate world, you will be held accountable for tasks that weren't even your responsibility in the first place.



OFFICE POLITICS #5

When you don't do it, you're lazy.
When your boss doesn't do it, he's too busy.

motifake.com

There are many different takes on this most common of attributes of a large corporate structure. Yet the basic fact remains, if you are given a responsibility, you need the authority to accomplish the task. It is a sign of poor management when you are given a responsibility with no authority.

In large corporations, you will be given tasks and responsibilities, and maybe a nice title. However, there will often be no authority with the new tasks. The end result will be a middle manager, or two, or three, that will hold up the entire process. One will be busy or on travel, or on vacation. You won't be able to move forward on your tasks because this lone manager is "sitting on" the approval.

Yet, finally, once the approval is granted, you will be held responsible for the delay in the project and the task. Your supervision and your manager will not accept your excuses, even though they will be true and accurate.

*[22] Any company that does not provide responsibility with individual authority is being **managed poorly**. The inability to control a task you are assigned is a very stressful event. Stress is generated by things that are beyond our control.*

Possessions own you

[via GIPHY](#)

One of the biggest and most significant lessons of working in a big corporation is that you exchange your time for money. You sacrifice your life; your time (your most valuable

commodity), and yourself for a handful of paper. That paper is exchanged for baubles to enhance your lifestyle.

Over time, after working in this environment for a few years, we forget things. We start to assume that the purpose of the work that we endure is for the pleasures of collecting baubles.

- That urgent need to get the latest iPhone when it first came out.
- Upgrade your car with some niceties.
- Purchase of that whimsy for your front yard.
- Getting a better set of wrenches for the garage.
- Buying that software game in the store, because it was on sale.

[via GIPHY](#)

As nice as these things are, are they really important? I argue that they are not as significant as we tend to believe. America is a consumer-focused nation, and a sizable portion of our money goes into taxes, followed with things we rent (our house, our car – Yes “Rent”, you don’t own anything you are making payments on.), then what is left over is often gobbled up with the purchase of baubles.

It is important, for us to get off that treadmill.

Stop the accumulation of possessions. Only buy what you need. Downsize, and save what money you can. By doing this, we attain control over our options. Work and the salary that we derive from it is no longer so important. We have the ability to be flexible and start being in charge of our life, as opposed to a “slave to the company”.



You work hard for the money. You should put it to good use. Do not waste it on baubles such as the latest iPhone, or a new collar for your dog. Save up the money. Then use it for things that matter to you. Maybe a vacation in a far-away land, dinner with that girl that you have wanted to spend some time with, or maybe do more. You can use the money to save for a business that you want to get started. Don't squander your assets. Put that money to good use.

Keep in mind that the more things that you possess fixes you into one physical location. It ties you down. Many of the things that you own loses their value quickly, and we tend to either put them in closets, garages or expensive storage units. They are things that no longer have any use to use. Quite the contrary, they force us with the need to earn more to replace them.

[23] The less you own, the more freedom you have. Do not fall into the trap of buying baubles to satiate a need that manifests from the corporate environment.

Do not confuse arrogance with confidence

One of the things that I have noticed in large corporations is that middle and upper management tended to have some very arrogant leaders.



Peter Stzrok, as senior level management of the FBI, is a smug arrogant son of a bitch. What a major asshole. He proudly said that no matter that Hillary lost the election, he would make sure that Donald Trump would get kicked out of the Presidency. Then he would make sure, as he had systems in place, that Hillary Clinton would take over one way or the other.

This is not always true, and indeed, many of the upper management in the smaller companies tended to be well-rounded, stable people with great ability.

However, the point remains that the long-duration corporate environment tends to create monsters. That's the best way that I can say it. Over time, they rise up through the ranks, they play the political games, and become very astute at it. Over time, maybe they rise up higher and obtain some real genuine perks. I saw this at GM, and there were some amazingly arrogant assholes in leadership positions.

Confidence is what you obtain through successfully navigating through the stresses of life.

Arrogance is what happens when the ego confuses confidence with ability.

The problem arises in the manifestation of arrogance. The coworkers and subordinates all suffer. This can vary in how it manifests. For instance...

- I worked at a glass company in Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania where the managers would throw chairs, and pots of coffee at you if they were unhappy.

- I worked in Shreveport, Louisiana where the management fired the housecleaning staff and brazenly told the white-collar engineering staff that from then on, our Saturdays belonged to the company. Our new job was to clean the offices on Saturday for eight hours for free.
- I worked in San Luis Obispo, California where I was told that I shouldn't go straight home after work. Instead that I was to "stick around" for an hour after I clocked-out to show "support" for the company.
- I worked in Hattiesburg, Mississippi where My salary was cut in half, and replaced with a few cartons of old products that they couldn't sell.
- I worked outside of Chicago and I was ordered to change my phone number to something easier for them to remember.
- I worked in Kokomo, Indiana and I was told that during the Christmas holiday that I was forbidden to drink any alcoholic beverages at home. If they found out, I would be fired.
- I worked in Erie, Pennsylvania where I was ordered to change my personal signature to something that my boss found more to his liking.
- I worked in Northern Indiana, at GM, and I was told that my car (a Mazda) was not welcome in the parking lot. So I was told that I should either buy a new car, or park away from the factory and walk to work.

The world might have people who are absolute assholes. There might be people who have poor social skills, and who want to rule the world... (Facebook, Google, or Twitter... anyone) and there are those who are just flush with their success. Remember that is not YOUR problem.



Martin Shkreli, a lightning rod for growing outrage over soaring prescription drug prices,, raised the price for his companies life-saving drug 4000%. He bought the company with money that he made on stocks. Then raised prices an enormous amount. He was arrested by the FBI after a federal investigation involving his former hedge fund and a pharmaceutical company he previously headed.

Eventually, arrogance is always part of a boomerang effect. The universe has a way of evening things out.

[24] Be humble no matter what your success is. Avoid having your ego take over, least you become an arrogant SOB.

Don't confuse comfort with success

Another thing we tend to confuse is comfort and success.

After fighting hard to land a “decent” job, we are often relieved and happy that the stress is over. We will be able to make our bills, and put some food on the table. Our spouse will stop hounding us to “get a job”, and we can relax somewhat.

The stress of being unemployed is much greater than any stress at a job (with some notable exceptions, that I had the misfortune to be associated with).

Corporate life can be comfortable. It's only when you start your own business that you realize quite how comfortable you were in that world. Sure, there was a level of stress, there were angry bosses, there were early starts and late finishes; but there was always a pay check.



Some people judge success in a way that can be measured. It is often associated with power, wealth and physical objects. This is the most common means of judging the success of a given person.

After a long, often too long, time looking for a job while unemployed, it is a major relief to be employed. Especially if you are working at a “good” company.

We have a tendency to relax somewhat.

As such, we go to work, day in and day out, and as we stay at the job we begin to associate our comfort at the job as a sign of our success. This is especially true if we have a raise or two in salary, and if we get along with the management. We think that we are comfortable and that comfort is a sure-fire sign of our success.

That is not true.

Not really. Indeed, that is ONLY true if your idea of success is working for someone else in comfort. Most people do not associate success with comfort. (Well, maybe those on Public Welfare might.) Different people define success differently. I, myself, will argue that success is the complete fulfillment of your purpose in this life.

| Success is the fulfillment of your God-given purpose.

This can be difficult to ascertain. We weren't born with an instruction manual. No one told us what our purpose in life was. Indeed, aside from the major religions who associate purpose with some kind of spiritual ideal or goal, most governments define success as total conformity with the laws of the nation where you reside.

What a messed up situation.



Other people judge success in other ways. Perhaps having an attractive wife, a caring and loving family, and being able to provide for them is a definition of success.

Now, the truth be told, you can find out what your spiritual purpose is. All you need to do is look deep inside of you and figure it out through contemplation, and prayer. You figure it out on your own. You might want to employ a hypnotist, or do some “past life regression” to help you in your quest. However, and whatever you believe, please understand that there is only one person who knows what your life purpose it.

That is you.

Is is not your boss at work. It is not your guidance counselor. It is not your psychologist or therapist. Is is not a major public personality on television. It is not someone on government and it is most certainly not your wife. There is only one person who knows what it is, and that is you.

Odds are that it has nothing to do with your work, or your job.

[25] Your success is defined by you, and you alone. It is not something that is associated with work, career, occupation, profession, salary or money in any way. The sooner that we realize this, the sooner we are able to realign the things that matter to us personally within our life.

You MUST have Passion for what you do

It doesn't matter what industry that you are in. You could be making hooks for the fishing industry, or working at a golf course. What ever you do, you must have a passion for it.

For instance, consider those people who have started their own beer breweries, All of them, every one, have one big piece of advice they are constantly dishing out to would-be beer entrepreneurs. Don't even think of doing it for the money. Only do it if you really, really want to brew beer for a living.

"All these folks have tales of spending their life savings on makeshift brewing equipment, traveling to a beer sampling event to find it had been canceled, having wayward distributors do nothing to sell their beer then asking for a rebate to pour it down the drain, sleeping on the floor of the brewery to brew overnight and many other confidence-bashing incidents."

It doesn't matter if you are trying to run your own company, or if you are working in a corporate environment. You must have a passion for what you do. You absolutely must.

DO WHAT YOU LOVE, **LIFE**.
AND DO IT OFTEN.
IF YOU DON'T LIKE SOMETHING, CHANGE IT.
IF YOU DON'T LIKE YOUR JOB, QUIT.
IF YOU DON'T HAVE ENOUGH TIME, STOP WATCHING TV.
IF YOU ARE LOOKING FOR THE LOVE OF YOUR LIFE, STOP;
THEY WILL BE WAITING FOR YOU WHEN YOU
START DOING THINGS YOU LOVE.
STOP OVER ANALYZING, ALL EMOTIONS ARE BEAUTIFUL.
LIFE IS SIMPLE. WHEN YOU EAT, APPRECIATE
EVERY LAST BITE.
OPEN YOUR MIND, ARMS, AND HEART TO NEW THINGS
AND PEOPLE, WE ARE UNITED IN OUR DIFFERENCES.
ASK THE NEXT PERSON YOU SEE WHAT THEIR PASSION IS,
AND SHARE YOUR INSPIRING DREAM WITH THEM.
TRAVEL OFTEN. GETTING LOST WILL

You need to do things that matter to you personally. Once we start doing and exchanging our time for objects, it becomes a downward slope into a dark abyss. Do not permit that to happen.

I know, I know, it's hard getting excited pouring over test spreadsheets and checking the numbers for quality control. But, the truth remains. If you do not have a passion for what you are doing, then eventually you will fail.

I used to have a dog that liked to dig. Man, this dog was a digging machine. He would dig anything up anywhere. I once left him in my mother's back yard for a weekend. I came back and found the entire yard littered with military-style "fox holes". It was in his nature.

I tried to break him out of the habit. I kept him indoors, and took him out on the leash. I would let him sleep in the garage. I did everything that I could do, but the first opportunity that he could dig a hole, man he would go to town. He would dig and dig and dig.

My dog has a passion for digging holes.

Yet, here I was trying to stop him. I not only did not share his passion, but I actively tried to suppress it.

Has that ever happened to you? Was there something that you really had a passion for, and others didn't care, or tried to suppress it? It sucked didn't it? You bet. That's life.

[26] Stay away from people, work, industry or anyone or anything that will suppress your passions. For a man without passion is a hollow, empty shadow of a man, indeed.

Time is more important than money

You can always make more money, but you can never make more time.

We waste time constantly. I am not talking about doing things that are unproductive. Because “productivity” is a relative thing. I am specifically talking about using time doing things that are useful and significant to you personally. Time wasters such as long and boring meetings waste your work time AND your personal time.



To some people, fishing is wasting time, as is watching soap operas. To other people, sitting on a porch carving a stick is a waste of time. Time and its use varies in importance from person to person. To some, sitting in a long and boring meeting is not a time waster because everything is together talking about work related issues. However, to me, I think it is a waste of time because I would rather be eating a nice sandwich and drinking an ice cold beer.

One of the most common mistakes people make is to look at the money that they make at a company and consider that the MOST important criteria in accepting a job there. They fail to take into account the time lost in commuting to and from the company. They forget to take into account the restrictions on vacation, and holiday time. They fail to take into account the requirements that place impositions on your private and personal time.

This is dangerous.

The most important thing that you have is your time. It is not the money you make. This is never clearer until when you get older. It is by far your most precious resource. And you start to realize how spending your time doing things for other people can actually be a waste.

- One company in Pensacola, Florida required that you work every holiday. The pay would be at the normal rate, with no holiday pay.

- One company in Waltham, Massachusetts insisted that everyone work on Christmas. The owners were not Christian, and thus felt that any workers can only take the holidays that they recognize in their religion. The result was that you had to work during the holidays at normal pay.
- My commute, when I first moved to Fort Wayne Indiana, was three hours to and three hours from work. This was because a new GM factory had moved to the area and no housing was available for miles.

[27] The most valuable thing that you have is time. It is not explicitly money. Never exchange your time for something that does not have value. Value can mean relationships, people, hobbies or anything that matters to you.

All that little stuff is unimportant

We often have a tendency to get so caught up in the trivial. What someone said to us. A parking space that someone else took. A cup of coffee that was cold. A harsh email, or response to a post on the blog. It's all just unimportant stuff. It's all meaningless.

We need to take a good look at the world around us. Find meaning in what we do, find meaning in our friends and relationships. We need to connect with nature and see the world as it actually is, and not view it from the prism of a computer monitor.



Most delays and problems in a corporate environment are caused by people. That's right, people are the weak chain in the schedule. Thus when an emergency comes up with an urgent to do list, it is usually the result of a failure of management. It is their problem, not yours.

One of the things wrong with many people in a corporate environment is the concept of "urgent" and "emergency". A supervisor or manager sits on a report for three months and the project starts getting late. To correct his incompetence, he declares the situation an "emergency" and an "urgent" task that needs to be resolved.

Nonsense.



HOUSTON, TX – AUGUST 30: A cat tries to find dry ground around an apartment complex after it was inundated with water following Hurricane Harvey on August 30, 2017 in Houston, Texas. Harvey, which made landfall north of Corpus Christi August 25, has dumped nearly 50 inches of rain in and around Houston. (Photo by Scott Olson/Getty Images)



Laura Mullane

18 hrs • 🌐



While I love both dogs and cats, we all know, when the chips are down, I'm a dog person. But that may change with this photo. All the photos I've seen of dogs and horses escaping the flooding, they look terrified. This cat just looks pissed—like he's going to write a sternly worded letter to his city councilor when he gets home...right after he smokes a few cigarette butts out of the gutter, does a shot of Jack Daniels, and starts **#bitchplease** trending on Twitter of pictures of dogs in boats. This cat had one fuck to give, and that fuck is gone.

[Since people are asking: Not my photo. Saw it on the Washington Post. Photo credit: Scott Olson / Getty]

This cat has had enough! Sometimes you need to identify what is a problem and what isn't. That is the way life is.

The only emergency that matters is if your child had a broken leg, or if you were suddenly being called to the IRS for a audit on your finances. Emergencies in a corporate environment are often *artificial* in origin. It is what is caused by piss-poor management. It is not caused by the workers who are jut trying to push their projects to completion.

[28] We need to categorize things in such a way that we only CARE and are influenced by things that actually matter. True and real emergencies are exceedingly rare in a corporate environment. Do not be fooled. One person's emergency is their and only their problem. Often it's just a name that is laid over the incompetence of others.

There is no guidebook on how to run your life

I know, I know. There are those that say to follow the Bible and everything will be clear. Others say, follow the United States Constitution and your life would be simple with liberty and freedom. Militant Muslims insist that the Koran has all the answers, while others have other ideas.



Here is a scene from the movie Bedazzled with the devil grants this man six wishes where he can have the life of his dreams. Of course, each reality that he accepts has a catch. So, do you think it might be nice to live the life of a Colombian drug lord, maybe?

When we go into a company they will provide us a handbook on how to act and behave and what rules the company has.

Combined, a man such as myself, will end up with numerous guides that he will try to follow. For me, in fact, I followed the United States Constitution, the Constitution and laws of the state where I lived, the Bible (most especially the New Testament), and the guidebook provided by the company where I worked.

However, I noticed that even though I followed and obeyed these most brilliant of documents, that my life somehow did not match the ideal as portrayed on the main-stream media.

I saw people like Bill Clinton becoming very rich and powerful, openly flaunting both the Bible and the Constitution, without consequence. I saw people getting promoted over me who were (seriously) not nearly as smart or brilliant, but who were promoted based on their relationships with others in the company. I saw absolutely mundane people “gaming the system” and getting away with it.



Another scene from the movie Bedazzled. What life do you want to live? Do you want to be a very popular and successful man living in a New York penthouse? If that is, indeed, your dream perhaps that can manifest. You just need to put your mind to it.

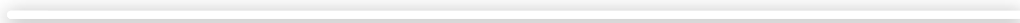
The point of this is that what happens to other people are NOT your concern. We need to stop comparing ourselves with others. We need to develop our interests in ourselves and our lives selfishly.

As such, there is no “manual” that will “be the ticket” to success. Since success is an individual phenomenon, there can be no manual. There can be no guidelines. There is nothing for us to follow. We have to carve our life out on our own.

[29] Our individual success is predicated on our ability to understand our personal needs and translate that into a recipe for living among other people. As such, there will be a long period of trial and error, with the risk of many a dead end. We cannot give up on this effort. Because it is precisely this journey that defines our purpose in this life. (Remember, our reality is created by our thoughts and our purpose is colored by the life lessons we learn.)

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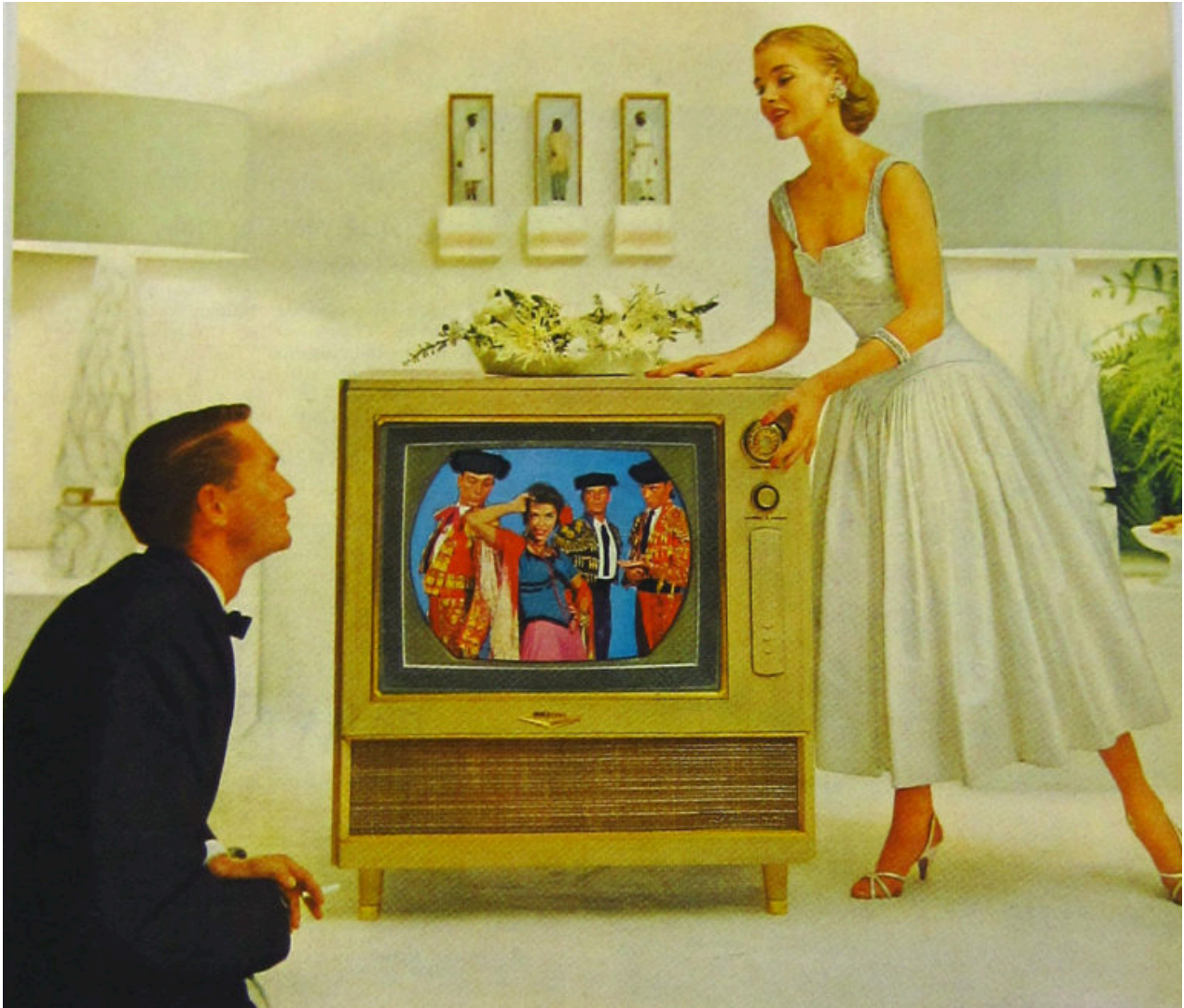
TV is a waste of time

If you recall, time is the most important possession that you have. It is not money or any other attributes. So here, consider the various ways that we trivialize this most important of attributes. Let's talk about the great time wasters of televisions, the internet, and games.

Granted it is a rare company that permits the employees to watch television during work hours. However, just about everyone in America turns on the television set once they get home from work. Or at least they did. Now, that might be displaced by the internet or some other type of social media device.

Since what you do immediately after work is tied to your labor, let's talk about it here and now. Television is a mindless device that is used to replace life.

The truth be told, as a child of the 1960's and 1970's, I wasted so much of my life spending 6 hours each day watching TV. Following shows that I just "had" to see, in order to "relax". Today, I regret almost every second of it. The whole world outside was passing me by.



Advertisements during the 1960's promoted the idea of glamor and excitement within the privacy of your own home. There, in big rich color were the passions and adventures that we all strive for. Just purchase this magical device and all your dreams can come true.

In what way did the show "Laugh In" improve my life? How did the "Flintstones", "Mayberry RFD", "Dragnet", "My Three Sons", "Star Trek" and "General Hospital" improve my life?

Ugh!

I know, I know, TV was an important part of the 20th century. It was important in bringing communication and news to the masses. It was important. It really was. However, you know, now today it's terribly wasteful.

Let's all be truthful with each other. People get biased news through it. They do so from habit, even though much better alternatives are available.

People watch terrible TV shows, and I do mean horribly terrible, they watch nonsense to substitute for living life in a reality that does not favor them. While it, teaches them nothing, it sucks so many hours of their lives away that they are oblivious to the damage. Overall, the people who live their lives vicariously through these artificial media delude themselves into thinking that they don't have time to pursue real passions in life.



Ah, is that Tiny Tim at the top of the heap for the 1960's major comedy show "Laugh In"? Ah, so many hours were wasted in watching this mindless entertainment.

Let's be honest, media such as the internet, computerized games and television encourage people to be antisocial. They cause people to hide away and cuddle with their media device. Whether it is a smart-phone, a television set, a radio or a computer, people now cuddle with the devices instead of with another person.

so...

[30] Live life in the physical. Do not substitute the electronic for reality. What ever you see or experience in any kind of electronic media is designed to manipulate you. Do not fall for this manipulation.

Limit the use of the internet

Speaking of the television being the great time waster, let's go next generation and talk about the ruinous internet.

Unlike TVs, the Internet is interactive and allows you to take part and become *virtually* social. It connects communities all over the world. It connects people together in a kind of fake reality. Here, people can pretend to be others, and carry on as if they are experts in things that they nothing about.



Stephen forgets that he isn't on the internet.

The Internet has evolved into a mechanism that anyone can communicate their feelings, ideas, and thoughts as long as they meet the requirements of those whom control it's access. Over the years, it has become clear that everyone has an equal voice on the Internet. Yet, the pure truth is that in "real life" most people would not give the "time of day" to many of the people that comment on the internet. They are often not worthy of our time. Thus, the need for a "grey web" was created. It is a "safe haven" for people to communicate and disseminate ideas and concepts free of disruption and contention.

Having said all this, we need to keep in mind that the internet is even a worse time waster than the television is.

Use the internet for function and purpose. If you decide to use it for pleasure, then do so judiciously. There are many things that are better to do in person than viewing them through the internet. May I suggest...

- Play with your cat instead of watching cat-videos.
- Go out with your friends and have a pizza together instead of sending pictures of pizza that you ate alone on Facebook.
- Pay for a *short-time* girl and enjoy the moment in person, instead of looking at porn on the internet.

Things are always better in person. Always.

[31] The internet is more dangerous than television because it is interactive. Limit your use of it. When given a choice, opt for doing things in person instead of virtually. It is easy to become addicted to the internet as you can pretend to participate in life instead of actually doing so.

Americans view foreign cultures in a stereotypical manner

Most Americans do not deal with foreigners. Yet, increasingly, the world is a global marketplace. Sooner rather than later, many Americans will find that they are forced to deal with foreign entities, workers and staff as part of their business. I, myself was first exposed to working with Brazilians and Russians back in the late 1980's, and all through the 1990's I worked throughout Asia.



Subway in Guangzhou. It's pretty typical. Most subways in China are state of the art, high-tech and modern.

The world outside of America has really grown in the last four decades. There was a rising middle class, and then a rising upper-middle class. Now, many of the nations in Asia all have a kind of familiarity to each other. They look futuristic and high-tech. Yet Americans are oblivious to this. We tend to think that just because our cities hardly changed that the rest of the world hardly changed either. That is not the case at all.

Shenzhen, China as viewed from the suburb of Futian. I particularly like the synchronized building lighting that is very popular in China.

Video Player

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Yup, this light show is normal. It is an *every-night* event.

One of the things that I discovered was that Americans, and myself included, had a very two-dimensional view of non-Americans.

Perhaps it was the non-stop barrage of “Save the Children” commercials, or maybe it was the images of Brazilian children foraging for food in these enormous garbage dumps. Maybe it was the onslaught of the images of (so called) child prostitutes that seemed to be everywhere in the UK news, or maybe it was the dated library books that showed 1960’s era images of foreign nations.

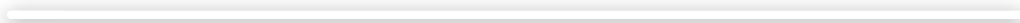
In any event, the result has been that Americans have a terribly distorted idea of what the rest of the world looks like. Maybe we think it looks kind of like El Paso, or a poverty stricken section of Jamaica. In any event, it really isn’t that way at all.

Rural China. China has spent billions of dollars upgrading infrastructure and the environment. In America, the moneys that are “earmarked” towards infrastructure and repair are often wholly absorbed in crime and corruption in the forms of bribes, siphoning of resources, and fraud. Not to mention, the enormous red tape and regulations that slow everything to a glacial pace. Not so in China. The money goes directly to the projects, with

armed Corruption Police making sure that nothing gets siphoned away into some rich cat's pockets.

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Things are quite cheap in rural China. The government has made every effort to preserve history and heritage. Unlike the United States where Civil War statues are being bulldozed for political correctness, the Chinese preserve their history.

Every country in the world is modernizing but this does not mean that they are westernizing or Americanizing. What makes them unique does not have to satisfy your “quaint” tourist-brochure view of them. Leave ignorant stereotypes aside and have an open mind about how modern life is like in that culture.

We need to realize that the world is filled with many people who are just like us. They might speak a different language, and have slightly different cultures, but fundamentally they want to work hard, raise a family and support it. They are really not very interested in the kind of world that is portrayed in the American mainstream news.

The Western city of **Shanghai, China...**

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Next time you read some news from CNN talking about some issue... question it.

Here's an example;

"Leave Immediately" - CNN Records Chinese Warnings Aboard Naval Flight Near Artificial Islands

Found [HERE](#).

If this news is to be believed, then CNN was [1] provided with a seat on a top secret monitoring aircraft. [2] That they booted an NFO or two, [3] somehow managed to get clearance not only to board the plane, [4] fly in the area in question, [5] listen in on the communication, [6] tape record the conversation, but also permitted to [7] publish the communication.

We are forced to believe that the Chinese Air Controllers spoke [8] American-style English [9] instead of Chinese, and did so in a [10] harsh tone.

All of this stretches the boundaries of credibility. Indeed, the comments on Zero Hedge just shows the disdain that people have for fake war-provocation nonsense from the mainstream American media...

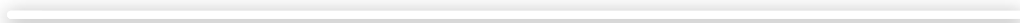
The question has to be asked, why was CNN allowed on a US military aircraft in the first place?

- [Keyser](#)

Guangzhou, China. The heart of the Southern industrial region...

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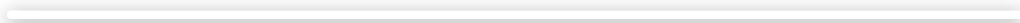
*[32] The world outside the United States is nothing like we have been led to believe. It benefits those in power to keep Americans dumb, manipulated and complaisant through fear. For us to be successful in our personal life, we need to see things personally, and experience them directly. We should treat all news, and anything that we do not **personally experience** with a healthy dose of skepticism.*

Finally, next time some crappy-assed American news-media is trying to promote conflict or another war, tell them to fuck off. It doesn't matter if it is Syria, Russia, China, or Iran. The world is not like it is portrayed by the American media. Not in the remotest.

Modern **Hong Kong, China...**

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Take your time

In the United States, I would often be berated to work at break-neck speed to meet these near-impossible (in many cases *actually* impossible) deadlines. Heck, a boss would promise that we could make a (mold) tool out of P3 hardened steel in three weeks. Three weeks!. That's a 36 week project if done properly, not including billing costs, delays in getting the material and structuring the work-force.

Many times, I felt like an overheated engine that just finished a marathon race with the engine pinging while it was cooling down. To survive I was prescribed anti-stress medication. The thing is, the human body is not designed to have Adrenalin coursing through your body for months at a time. The "fight or flight" mechanism is a short time event measured in minutes or a few hours. It is not designed for sustained use.

America is a land where you NEED medication just to exist.

If there's one thing I've learned from living in countries that are more "easy going" it's that they are much better in their *pace of life*. Brazil, Thailand and Cambodia come to my mind readily. On the other side of the coin are nations like the United States. People and countries that do everything quicker also do it worse. Take it easy and go slowly.

Enjoy every bite of food. Savor it.



You need to savor the food that you eat. Eat the food in bites and taste every morsel. Make sure that you are able to concentrate on the food, and not mindlessly chow down while you are reading the news on the internet. Make sure that you wash the food down with a good and delicious beverage, like maybe a Southern style iced tea, or maybe a nice Corona with a lime wedge. Enjoy the food. Taste the food.

Be mindful. Spend time outside. When the sky is electric blue, and the trees are lush green, take it all in.

When you walk, do it at a purposely slow pace and take in your surroundings. Take your time. relax. Spend time with your loved ones, your friends, and the environment that surrounds you. When they speak to you, listen.



Bacon, especially cooked properly is something that should be enjoyed. I myself, like to eat it alone or as part of a fine sandwich. I would suggest a nice BLT (bacon, lettuce, and tomato) on toasted bread with sweet mayonnaise. Another suggestion is a club sandwich, a turkey club is good as well. Just make sure that you have french fries and cole-slaw with it. Oh, and by the way, make sure that you have properly cold beer to wash this all down. You can't go wrong with this winning combination.

When you work, do it at YOUR pace. Not at a pace defined by someone else. If you generate a timeline, and they tear it up and cut it in half, make sure that *they* (and not you) are responsible for any delays. If you know that they will not take on this responsibility, then start looking for another job. For you might be good, but you are not God.

[33] Take your time in doing any task. Go at the speed and the pace that works best for you. If you find that your pace is not suitable by your management, go elsewhere. Life is too short to change your way of doing something to fit the desires of others.

You can't please everyone

As you get older, you start to realize that there is no way that you can please everyone. In fact, the chances are that there will be very few people that you will be able to please. Everyone will have an opinion. Everyone will have an idea of what you can do to better yourself.



Yeah, everyone has an opinion on how to live your life. They will offer helpful suggestions, and try to teach you lessons, as long as they can profit from it. Don't believe them. No one else is walking in your shoes. No one else knows what you know and your situation. You must follow your heart and ignore the rest.

If you make a mistake, they will loudly state that you were a fool and that they would have never be put in the situation that you were in. Yeah. Right. That is one of the most common things that is heard in prisons, that the inmates never thought that they would ever go to prison. They felt that they were smarter, better or wiser than others.

Nonsense.

You are you. You have your own experiences, and your own way of doing things. Do things your way and let the rest howl in frustration.

[34] Do what you do for your own purposes. Never try to please anyone else. Do not change your opinion for anyone else either. Be yourself or be a pale shadow of someone else's image.

Trying to be cool is useless

Trying to be cool is something that we should outgrow in school. It is a mechanism that we use to enter various social communities. In the 1940's, a "cool" person would eat goldfish. In the 1960's a "cool" person would drop acid. In the 1970's a "cool" person would wear a "choke collar". Today, being "cool" means being a metro-sexual, promoting LGBT diversity and eating guacamole on your whole-wheat bagels.

Nonsense.

[via GIPHY](#)

In the corporate environment, being “cool” means that you have decided to be a sheep and not a leader. You decided that you would rather join some clique or club group rather than go your own way. It means that your ego is so fragile that you would rather give up something that is fundamentally part of you to belong to a society of like-minded individuals.

You follow the rules and obey the written and unwritten laws. You are an accepted part of the work community and that is in itself... “cool”.

When you get older, you start to see the folly in all this.

Now, there is a very interesting thing that happens when you are in a corporate environment. With your ego supplanted by the corporate ideal, you need to start to do little things that scream “I am a man, I am not a number!”.

[via GIPHY](#)

You put special pictures on your desk in specially selected frames. You might start using a colored pen, or pencils. You might purchase a desk mat that identifies your working cubicle as “yours”. You might put a pillow on your chair, or do some other kind of small rebellious action that is small but personally significant.

Whether at work, or at home, be yourself. Do so whether it is “cool” or not. many companies have an unwritten dress code that you are supposed to conform to. A cool person would obey the dress code, but have some kind of rebellious streak that might set them apart. It would be their statement of individuality.

This might mean swapping out the white buttons on a long-sleeved white shirt for colored ones. It might mean wearing sneakers instead of oxfords at work. It might mean wearing a black tie, when everyone in your department is wearing a red one.



Corporate drones are not permitted the luxury of individuality. They are to fit their role and to operate within their narrowly defined work constraints.

If you feel the need to stand out, to act cool, then you should be made aware that something is wrong. Your ego is shouting at you that you no longer belong in the society that you are now a part of. You need to bail. You need to exit it quickly before events proceed beyond your ability to manage them.

[35] Being “cool” is something that adults grow out of. If you ever feel the need to rebel, then that need is a warning sign that you are in a situation where you do not belong. Listen to the alert. Take action.

Make mistakes – and make LOTS of them!



This brilliant work holds a special meaning to me. True and real art evokes the senses and evokes emotion. So when the progressive liberals talk about the “brilliance” of Picasso, I always ask them this simple question; “What emotions do you feel when you see his work?” If they pause in their response, they are just parroting a narrative of sheep that follows the “emperor with no clothes on”. Real art evokes emotion. Anything less than that is not art.

Mistakes are how we learn.

It is well understood that a person who has made no mistakes never made anything. For all the brilliant books and stories that Ray Bradberry wrote, he wrote many, many more that did not become so popular. For all the brilliant paintings that [Daniel F. Gerhartz](#) painted, he had painted many, many more lesser works (see the work above).



Everyone makes mistakes. However some mistakes are more serious than others. Never the less, we need to forge forward and do our best regardless of the nay-sayers.

[36] Make mistakes. Keep on moving forward, never back. Do not try to live a mistake-free life. Mistakes happen to those who live life.

Stop thinking so much

You know, we all really have got to stop over-thinking so much. We really do. We all know the story about the person trying to shoot an arrow. It's [1] Ready, [2] Aim, and [3] Fire. Yet many people don't follow this advice. They either go...

- Ready.... Ready.... Ready.... Ready....
- Fire!
- Ready... Aim.... Ready.... Aim....



Way.

I think the biggest problem that we need to overcome is the problem that we tend to over-think everything. We think this, and we think that. We wonder what others are thinking

about us. We try to conduct an analysis of our particular situation. We think, and we think, and we think some more.

It tends to drive us crazy.

Stop. Just stop this nonsense. Do not over-think anything.



No Way

I personally believe that one of the causes of over-thinking things is when we spend time outside of nature. We are not getting enough fresh air. We are not walking about outside enough. We are not being near the beach, or hiking in the mountains enough. We need to reset ourselves.

We need to get out of the boxes that cause us to generate self-neuroses.

Because that is one of the aspects of over-thinking; neuroses.

[via GIPHY](#)

[37] Stop thinking too much. To a task, and then forget it. Stop caring what other people think and what they do. Take care of yourself and spend more time outside in nature. It will help you get a handle and put some control over your thought process.

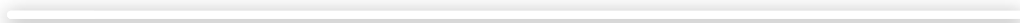
Dance and sing whenever possible

In the United States, it is culturally frowned upon to express yourself with the corporate environment. Everyone has a role within the extents of their job responsibilities. Once they leave the work environment, many can spend their free time involved in the things that matter to them. Often this is a mixture of television, the internet and household chores. Really, not too many Americans spend the time at the pub, brasserie, or KTV to dance and sing.

That is not true in other countries. In fact, it seems like everyone in Asia loves to dance and sing. Some of them are really, really good...

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That is really sad.

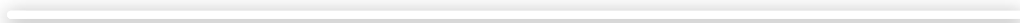
Which is one thing that I really like about China. When I am out with the other bosses, we go out to the KTV and sing our hearts out, as well as dance the night away. Let me tell you, life is too short not to enjoy life. Stop doing what that old biddy down the street wants you to do.

Come on. Go out, get that cigar that you have been wanting to smoke. Go ahead, ask that girl out. Don't be afraid and eat that deep-fried Monti Crisco sandwich. If you start to worry about everything, you are living a life in fear. Sing. dance. Drink the wine with both hands and then wipe your mouth with your sleeve.

Come on, if this fella can "beat it", so can you...

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Don't be afraid what other people think. You can dance. Heck if 95 year old men can dance to Michael Jackson, then so can you. Or maybe you disagree with me. Maybe you think that it is classy to obey those whom you work for, be afraid to show emotion, style or class.

You know, you don't need to know how to dance to dance. In fact, you can just do jumping jacks, or hop around to the beat. Do sort of a electronic version of "The Grateful Dead" when you dance in public....

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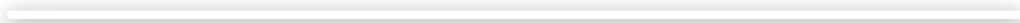
Life is too short not to enjoy it.

I took professional dancing lessons, and for a period of time in my life, dancing was a very important part of my life. Still, whenever I get a chance I get up and start to dance. You know, you do not need to be able to dance well to be able to dance. You just follow the music.

Of course, one of the secrets about dance is precision. Really good dancers just have a very good control of some very simple and basic dance moves. They just move these basic moves in a very precise manner....

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Now, I cannot sing worth shit, but when there is a chance to sing some country and western music, get out of my way. I am going to sing my heart out. Seriously you all need to stop being so serious. Get a little crazy. have fun.

If you cannot sing, then fake it. Lip sync.

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[38] *Who cares about what you do for a living, if you are not enjoying yourself? You must be living your life to it's fullest. Otherwise you are not living. You are existing. Don't do that.*

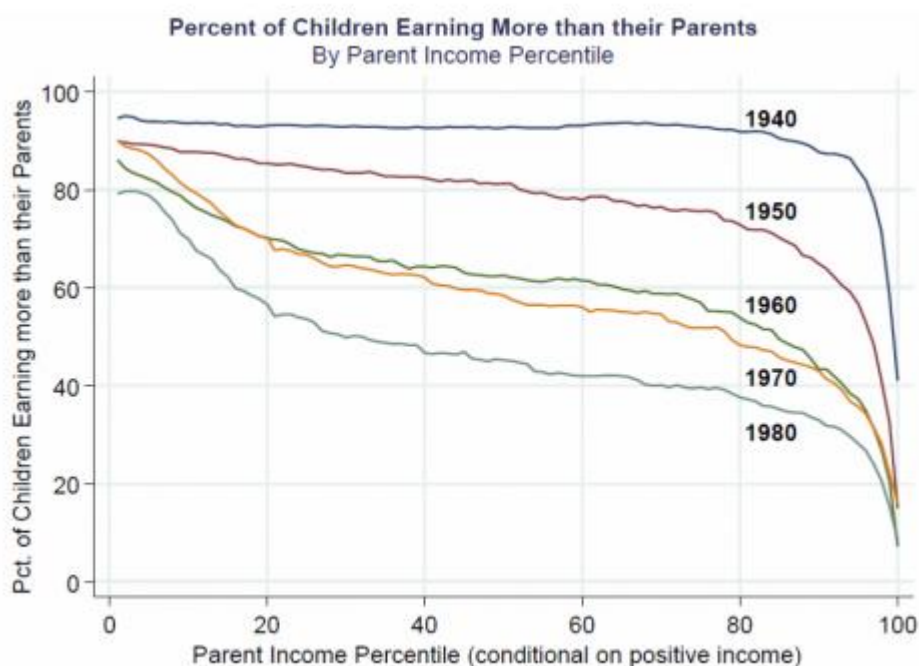
Do not take anything for granted.

One of the things that you learn as you get older, is that you just cannot count on anything. You just don't know when the rug will be pulled out from under you, and you will be stranded with your dick in your hand.

Please don't take anything for granted.

Treasure every single moment you have. If you are in a corporate environment, then know that one day you will be replaced. maybe you are too expensive, maybe your customer decided to leave, maybe someone is bad mouthing you, maybe the company owner has a son-in-law that wants your job. You don't know. Anything can happen. All that you can control is your thoughts and how you carry yourself.

Do you best. Know that things change. Do everything you can to enjoy the life that you have at that very minute, because life can change in a New York Minute. Don't be caught off guard. It is a fact of life.



Over the years, the opportunities afforded to American citizens have been evaporating at an alarming rate. We should realize that the opportunities afforded our grandparents are no longer available to our children. We should not take it as a given that there will be opportunities in America for us. Things change, and the trends are alarming.

One day you will lose those that are closest to you. One day you might lose all your possessions, your bank account might end up empty. You might lose your health, become terribly scarred or paralyzed, or even worse. Don't think it cannot happen to you. Anything is possible in this world. yes, and the bad things can happen just as readily as well as the good things.

[39] Don't think that the situation that you are in will last forever. Things change. So do not take life for granted. Treasure every moment. Tell those you love how you feel about them. Say nothing bad or harsh, and appreciate the world around you.

Friends and Relationships are important

If there is one thing that I have learned over the years is the importance of a network of friends. If you lived the kind of life that I have, it's hard to make friends when you have to move to another state every year or so. Eventually you give up and you all just keep to yourselves.



Cultivate your friendships. Enjoy life with them. Spend time together and make a special point to cherish your extended relationships. Scene is from the movie "Hangover II".

Yet the truth is that you need friends and family. You help them when they need it, and they help you out when you need it. So one of the first priorities that you need to do is establish a network of friends where ever you live. Cultivate them. This network can be associated

with church, a hobby, or just random strangers. However, what ever you do, cultivate them. Do not take them for granted. Appreciate them.

[41] You NEED friends. Make friends, cultivate them. Cultivate and stay in contact with your family. No matter what happens at your corporate job, your friends will still be there for you.

Remember what friends are for...

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Conclusions

As someone who spent most of his working life trapped with a corporate crucible, I wish to share my biases and thoughts in regards to the culture that has developed in corporate America. In short, it is important to be true to yourself and your purpose in life. If you are not careful, you will exchange your very being for some shiny baubles. So I would advise everyone to be careful.

Take Aways

- The more hoops your jump through the get the job, the worse you will be treated.
- Value does not equate with money.
- You are only as valuable for what you can provide.

- Companies operate above the law.
- Meetings are a waste of time.
- Everyone basically wants the same thing.
- Don't defer your happiness for the future.
- You need game.
- Efficiency is a lie.
- Nobody cares.
- Be practical.
- There is no such thing as 'Destiny'.
- Desk Jobs will kill your creativity.
- Avoid "Echo Chambers".
- Living a good life is the best way to convince people.
- Nobody has the answer.
- It's fine to say "I've made a mistake".
- You are going to have to work hard.
- More money will not solve all your problems.
- Respect is earned.
- The 360 Review is dangerous.
- Responsibility should come with authority.
- Possessions own you.
- Do not confuse arrogance with confidence.
- Don't confuse comfort with success.
- You must have passion.
- Time is more important than money.
- All that little stuff is unimportant.
- There is no guidebook.
- Television is a waste of time.
- Limit the use of the internet.
- Foreign nations are viewed stereotypically.
- Take your time.
- You cannot please everyone.
- Trying to be cool is pointless.
- Make mistakes.
- Stop thinking so much.
- Dance and sing when possible.
- Do not take anything for granted.
- Friends and family are important.

FAQ (For Parts 1&2)

Q: Do you think that all corporations are the same?

A: No. Not in the least. I think that there are many, many different types of companies,

corporations and organizations. However, they all eventually develop their own types of individual social controls. When you work in the environments that surround these social controls you need to adapt. I suggest that the adaptation that we go through can be dangerous and limiting to our overriding purpose in life. Herein are my suggestions to assist in the survival of one's purpose within the corporate structure.

Q: Why did you write this post in two parts?

A: I find that the trend on the internet has been to migrate posts and articles into two paragraph bite-sized chunks. People today have a short attention span. Yet my posts, by modern internet standards are enormous. Actually, this post could have been easily broken up into 40 blog posts were I to follow the culturally acceptable posting guidelines (and Googles SEO guidelines), but heck, I think higher of my readership than that. I broke it into two posts due to the size limitations on word-press (10,000 words max). Other than that, the system crawls to a very slow pace.

Q: Were there other things that you could have added to this list?

A: Oh yes. Find love, for instance. Come in early for work, even if no one notices. Oh, and that oldie, but goodie, *"Don't piss off your boss"*.

Q: Why are all your embedded videos from China?

A: I live in China, and that is what I have available to me.

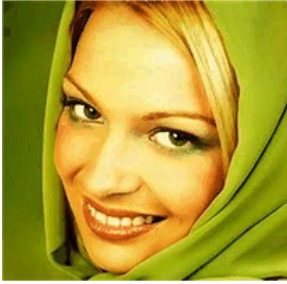
You-Tube is an excellent resource, but since it is directly connected to the NSA servers (as is Google and Facebook, Pinterest, and Tumblr) it is banned, (The Chinese government does not want the American government to have complete files on it's citizens.) and I would need to use a VPN to access. That's not a big problem, getting a VPN in China is an easy enough thing to do.

But, you know, there is a bigger selection of choices in China than in the United States. It's not because China is better, it's simply because China is much, much, much larger than the United States in population.

In the United States you go into the grocery store, and go into the potato chip aisle. There might be a thousand different bags, of which there are five basic types, another five odd-ball types, and three brands. In China you would have three thousand bags, 300 different types, and 500 brands. The selection in China is much larger given the size of the nation.

Posts Regarding Life and Contentment

Here are some other similar posts on this venue. If you enjoyed this post, you might like these posts as well. These posts tend to discuss growing up in America. Often, I like to compare my life in America with the society within communist China. As there are some really stark differences between the two.



The Most Important Things That a Man Looks for in a Woman.

Here, we look at the things that men search for in a woman. These things are considered, by men, to be absolutely essential in a mate. We discuss ten attributes and go into detail as to why they are important.



Adventures Exploring the Cemeteries of Indiana

Cemeteries can tell us a lot about ourselves, our history, and our future. This is most especially true in regards to smaller and remote cemeteries located in the counties that surround us. This is my story about the impressions that my forays into these curiosities made upon me.



What it was like being a kid in the early 1970's

This is my narrative of what it was like growing up as a young teenager in 1971. This took place in the hills of Pennsylvania outside of Pittsburgh. I was 13 years old. I went to school, rode my bicycle around everywhere. I fished with my father, and watched television a lot.



The Fiasco of the Reengineering of the Common Tomato

This is the sad, sad story about how the wonderful and tasty tomato was reengineered to be "better". It was made better to ship. Better to sell. Better to store. However, there was one thing missing. No one paid any attention to taste, which is why it tastes like a cardboard shipping box today.



A Movie Tribute to the 1980's When Ronald Reagan Ran America.

Here we argue that movies reflect society when they were made. Today we see popular movies being remade as all female versions due to the progressive realities today. Likewise, the movies of the 1980s reflected the time when they were made as well.



Mad Scientist Explorations

Here we discuss what it was like growing up as a boy in the 1960's and the 1970's and the people, things, and adventures that inspired us. As such, we explore how the independence of growing up enabled us to cope through life when we got older.



The Gorilla Cage in the Basement

When I was a small boy, I used to play in the abandoned buildings nearby. Here is a story about one of the objects that lay hidden inside one of those buildings and the possible mysteries that it held. As a child we thought it was a gorilla cage, now as an adult, I am not so sure...



The Importance of a Family Meal Together

There is nothing more important and satisfying than spending time together with friends and family and eating a meal together. It is a time of friendship, familial bonding and relaxation. Here we discuss what I have learned from my childhood and how I apply it today in my life.



The Pleasures of Fresh Baked Bread with Butter

One of the things that I have come to miss, since I moved to China, is fresh hard crusty rolls with full salted butter. The Chinese are not really fans of crusty bread. They like sweets and sponge cakes. Here I describe something that is close to me; not appreciating what you have right in front of you.



What Work was Like in the 1960's and 1970's.

When people go to work today, they find that there are all kinds of rules and regulations. It is for diversity, safety, inclusion, and improvement in a new progressive world. Well, here is what work was like before it became a sterile progressive testing ground for the New World Order.



Learning during my 1970s High School years

Here is a pretty long post on what it was like to go to elementary school in the 1960's, and then attend high school in the 1970's. I graduated in 1977, and that my friend is exactly the target date for the famous movie "Dazed and Confused". Here is the real deal what it was like.



Some True Stories of Cat Heaven

Being in MAJestic taught me many things. One of which was an intimate understanding of Heaven and other "spiritual" things relative to quanta entanglements. Here I discuss what it is like to have a beloved animal (cat) dies and what actually happens to them and why.



Life Lessons from Working within the Corporate Dream – 1

After I was trained by MAJestic, I was left to fend for myself in Corporate America. It was a hellish existence. As such, I learned many lessons concerning behavior and the ultimate impact that it holds on our families, our friends, our loved ones, and our very lives. Here are my commentaries.



Life Lessons from Working within the Corporate Dream – 2

This is part two of the two part section. There is quite a lot of information to impart. Stories are told, and experiences relayed. Honestly working in corporate America in the 1980's, through the new century really sucked. It was harsh on everyone except the owners of the companies.



How to Build Up Your Life from Nothing.

This is for all those young men who are just leaving school and trying hard to build up their life. You can do it. Here are my thoughts and advice for a young man who is encountering that most difficult of challenges; carving your life out in the wilds of the world.



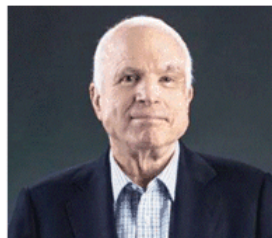
Allow your Children to Play and Grow (Part 1)

I am horrified, just horrified, that parents do not allow their children to play, roam and explore on their own. It has created a society of pampered fearful children. Here I discuss this in terms of what I know. This is very non-PC and might offend the more liberal readers out there.



Allow your Children to Play and Grow (Part 2)

This is the second part of my rant about permitting children to play, explore and have fun. Everyone, the odds that some stranger will abduct your child is very small. Most people who do this are family friends and neighbors. Stop being so fearful. It harms the development of your child.



Ode to Diabolical Cretin John McCain

Well, that evil son-of-a-bitch is finally dead. If his grave wasn't so far away, I go there and dance on top of it. This guy has spent his life backstabbing people, hurting people, concocting wars, and doing everything in his power to disrupt the lives of people. Good fucking riddance.



The Song "Baby Got Back" Translated into Latin

Here is a fun post. The song "Baby Got Back" is translated into Latin and then back again. I have to tell you that it is indeed hilarious. *Rebecca, ecce! tantae clunes isti sunt!* (Rebecca, behold! Such large buttocks she has!) Anyways, it's just all fun and games. Enjoy.



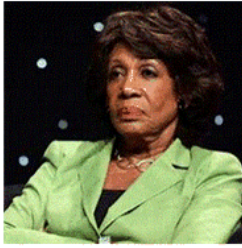
Every Man Should Have a Roll-Top Desk

It's true, and I discuss why. A roll-top desk is made for the person who accumulates the clutter of the road as they forge their way through life. The desk becomes a symbol and a place for a man's privacy. It is a place where he has control over his life, and a place to store his treasures.



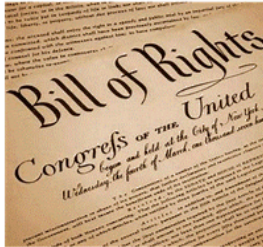
Why Women Need their own Personal Makeup Vanity Space

I am a strong believer that everyone needs privacy and a personal space to call their own. In this post I discuss the need for a woman to have a vanity and why it is important for a woman to spend time using it. Everyone, regardless of their situation, needs a place that is all theirs and theirs alone.



What the Progressive Liberals have in store for Conservatives

The progressive socialists, who now go under the name of "Liberals", have plans on the consolidation of their power and control. This is what their ultimate plans are. It does not bode well for traditional American values, Rights, the Constitution, or history. It's going to be a dangerous time.



The Warning Signs that Government Collapse is Imminent

All nations go through cycles. They do so, and when they mature they evolve into other governmental forms. The United States is long overdue for a change; a reset. Now, while this will occur, it is unknown how severe it would be. Here are my thoughts on this issue and some warnings.



Democrat Busybodies and the Destruction of Freedom

Wouldn't life be wonderful if you could just be left alone and live your life in peace? I think so. The founders of the United States thought so, however there is an army of busybodies who disagree. They have this vision of utopia where everyone listens to their commands.



Adventures of a 70's Kid in an Army And Navy Store

Here we look at what adventures an Army and Navy store could hold for the inquisitive child. We talk about the history and the inherent adventures that lay hidden in dusty boxes, and dark corners. We narrate the exploration through the eyes of nostalgia. It's a pleasant excursion.



Comparison between American and Chinese Playgrounds

The differences between American and Chinese playgrounds couldn't be more telling. It is a tale of how things are handled differently and the roles that parents take. In China the role of the parent is to equip the child for life. While in America it is to protect the child from life.



Excuses We Use That Keep Us Enslaved

Here we look at what an American *actually* is. For the argument made here is that citizenship in the United States is not what qualifies a person to be an "American". Rather it is the way a person thinks, the way they act, and their general philosophy in life. For not everyone is an American.

More Posts about Life

I have broken apart some other posts. They can best be classified about ones actions as they contribute to happiness and life. They are a *little different*, in subtle ways.



On Being an Older Gent

Here are my thoughts on growing old as a man. The truth is that the life that I expected to have as I was growing up never materialized. Instead, something else manifested. My life today is nothing compared to what I thought it would be. For my illusions were created by American media.



Be Who You Are

All our lives we are told who to be, what to do, what career to take. Our religion, our work, our schools, our government, and our loved ones all tell us what we need to do. Here, I tell you the opposite. Stop allowing others to tell you what to do. You know what you need inside of you.



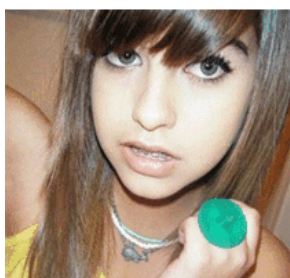
Calexit and the American Civil War

This is a pretty detailed look at the causes of the American civil war, and why it wasn't about slavery. We look at the rewriting of history by the internet, and the efforts that President Obama took to keep California intact so that the Democrats could maintain political power and control.



Why an American man should leave America and Travel

All people should get up off their duff and go forth and Travel. However, this is most especially true for American men. The United States has become a crucible of PC progressive realities that attack and depreciate American men. Go out, young man, see the world as it really is!



The Amazing Bremelanotide PT-141

Forget Viagra, and all those other ED medications. This is the real deal. This little baby causes humans to *go into heat*. It interacts with the brain and sets up feelings of intense arousal on both men and women. It turns people into 16 year olds. As such it is banned in the USA by the FDA.



Bronco Billy and the 25th Law of Power

Bronco Billy is a fictional movie starring Clint Eastwood. The movie depicts the life of a man who decides to change his life and go ahead and do what he has always dreamed of doing. He goes out and becomes his dream. There are lessons here for all of us, we only need listen.



The r/K Selection Theory applied to American Politics

The r/K theory is a pretty well-known theory on animal behavior. It simply states that animals behave as they need to based on the scarcity of resources. Here, we argue that it can be applied to why humans follow different political philosophies. Especially in American politics.



How they get away with it

Ten years ago, Bankers committed fraud in Wall Street that just about devastated the nation. Earlier, we had the S&L fiasco, the nightmare with penny stocks, and now the grand wholesale treason with the selling of Top Secrets to a foreign nation. This is how they get away with it.



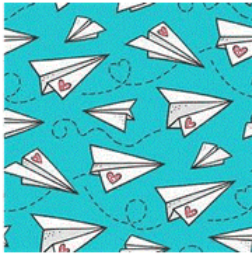
The Line in the Sand – Now What?

It's the same story. Just vote for us, and we will correct everything. Yet, nothing ever happens. You know, boys and girls, this old "song and dance" can only be maintained for so long. Eventually it will fractures, and people will no longer rely on elections to institute change...



The importance of having a second passport.

So President Trump is building a wall to protect Americans. Hum. Where have I heard that before? Oh yes, in Germany right when they were making the wall that separated Berlin. Walls serve two purposes; they keep people out, but they also keep people in. Be careful what you wish for.



How Rocket Scientists Build Paper Airplanes

This is a tale of what me and my classmates used to do when we were young Aerospace Engineering students at the university. We would design paper airplanes and shoot them down with bottle rockets. Here is just a fun little exercise down “memory lane”. Enjoy.



What is Snopes.com and can it be Trusted?

Snopes is a “fact check” website that is fully funded by the oligarchy. It is used to “shout down” any narratives that does not support the rich and powerful, and politically connected globally. Here we discuss the organization, who they are and what they represent.



Today America Taxes it's Expats without Representation.

This is a sad state of affairs. Americans who reside outside of the United States now have to pay American taxes, even though they have no representation in Congress. As I recall this was one of the reasons for the American cry for independence in 1776.



What life is like inside the ADC Prison in Arkansas

This post discusses what life is like in a hard labor prison in Southern Arkansas. We discuss hoe squads, food, the hole, commissary, dress, fashion, homosexual culture, prison gangs, murders, relationships and other aspects of life when you are sentenced to “Hard Time”.



The Hazing of New Employees – A Lost Tradition

Up until the 1980's all companies would haze new employees. Today, we live in a world regulated by the government and policed by Human Resources. We forget how things used to be just a handful of decades ago. Here is my narrative when I started to work.



How to Build a Gallows and a Hangman's Noose

The United States is entering a period of strife. There will be violence. There will be discord and discomfort. It will be an ugly time. There will be winners and losers. It will be painful for the losers, and the victor will need build a gallows. This is how to do so and why it is needed.



Some things that need to be changed for America to be the "Land of the Free" again.

There are many things that a person can do to improve themselves. But, what about a nation? What about the United States? Here is a handful of suggestions that I would like to propose to help America become whole again.



A Wish List of Favorite Firearms

This is a personal list of many favorite firearms that I would like to own. There are various reasons for the particular weapon of choice, and I provide my reasons. This post has no other purpose than to express my desire to own certain weapons that I cannot as an American.



The Ultimate Method to Make Your Computer Safe and Secure

The best way to make your computer secure and private is to have very strong encryption and use an obscure operating system that very few people know about. Here we look at 37 obscure computer operating systems.



Is America a Republic or is it a Democracy – What is it?

Here we take a nice good look at what the United States is today. We look at reports that are suggestive of other governmental organizations. We look at what is going on contemporaneously inside the United States, and we look at how the United States behaves globally.



The Many Things that Democrats want to Ban

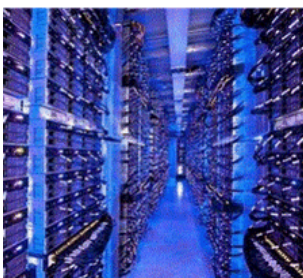
This is a running list of the many things that American Democrats want to ban, have banned, or are trying to ban. You know, a ban of anything is a restriction on freedom. That is not what America was founded upon. Yet, here we are today. Everyday is a new ban, and loss of freedom.



Nations that an American Man could Travel and Relocate to – Part 1 Here, I suggest places where an American man could go if he wanted to start all over again. You know, this happens. Often a man will go through a nasty divorce, or get raked over the coals by a business associate or the United States government. When it happens, it's time to start new.



Nations that an American Man could Travel and Relocate to – Part 2 Here, I suggest places where an American man could go if he wanted to start all over again. You know, this happens. Often a man will go through a nasty divorce, or get raked over the coals by a business associate or the United States government. When it happens, it's time to start new.



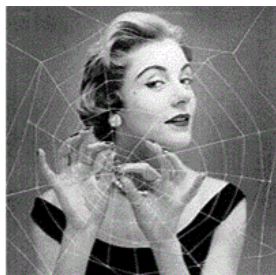
Alternative Search Engines instead of Google

Google does two things that I do not like. Firstly, they vacuum up everything you do and send the information straight to the American deep state; the NSA and DHS. Secondly, they censor your results for you according to what they think you should see. Here we look at alternatives.



The Consequences of the #MeToo Movement

While the #MeToo movement burst forth onto American culture with good intentions, it was soon coopted by those with selfish and sinister intent. The aggressive nature of the accusations, and the consequences of being accused became dangerous. Here we look at the corporate aspect.



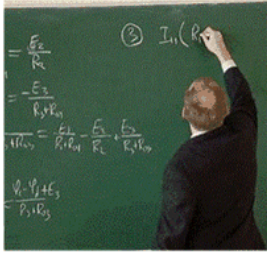
The Lies the Media Tell Us

The United States mainstream media does not report "news". Instead they fabricate events that are designed to manipulate. They do not employ reporters. They employ actors and they stage events for public display. Let's talk about this serious situation and how to avoid manipulation.



What it was like Growing Up in 1960's and 1970's America

Here is my narrative of some stories of what it was like growing up as a kid in the 1960's and the 1970's. It was a time of freedom, and we took full advantage of it. I'll tell you what. I discuss a little about the clothing, friendships, and relationships of that time.

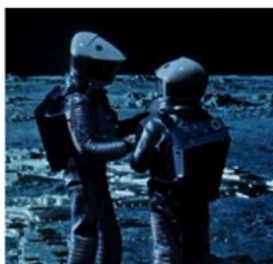


What High School Taught me About Democracy

America was formed as a Republic. Yet, for many decades we were brought up in the notion that the United States is the greatest “Democracy” in the history of the world. I have my own opinions about that. Democracy is “mob rule”. Let’s talk about it from what I learned in my High School.

Stories that Inspired Me

Here are reprints in full text of stories that inspired me, but that are nearly impossible to find in China. I place them here as sort of a personal library that I can use for inspiration. The reader is welcome to come and enjoy a read or two as well.



Robert Heinlein’s “The Long Watch” – Full Text

What if you were in charge of all the nuclear weapons in the world, and your base Commander checks your political leanings to see if you are willing to conduct a coup d’état. What would you do? Would you go along with the opportunity, or would you be a lone hero?



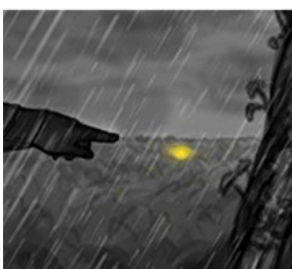
Kaleidoscope (Full Text) A Story by Ray Bradbury

This is the full text of a short story by Ray Bradbury. It concerns the final moments of a crew of spacemen as they drift about in space helplessly after their space rocket explodes. They know that no one can help them as they await their final moments tumbling through space...



Here There Be Tygers by Ray Bradberry

When I was younger I used to read science fiction stories for pleasure. They filled my minds with adventure and passion. One of my favorite authors was Ray Bradberry and here is a complete reprint of one of the stories that has influenced me to be the man that I am today. Enjoy.



The Long Rain (Full Text) by Ray Bradberry

This is the full text of a most excellent science fiction story. It concerns a group of survivors from a crashed spaceship stranded on a Hellish rainy planet; the tropical cloud-covered Venus. They survive the crash, but have to battle the forces of nature and their own passions.



The Fog Horn (Full Text) by Ray Bradbury

Here is a story about the emotions of being the last of your kind. This story is one that influenced me when I was a young boy in the 1970's and continues to haunt me to this day. All of us are human. We all feel emotions and passions. They drive us to accomplish or destroy. It's our choice.



The Rocket (Full Text) A Story by Ray Bradbury

This is a nice short story about a poor man who dreamed about flying into space. No matter how hard he worked, and no matter how much he saved, he was never able to provide for that dream. Then one day, when he was asked to scrap a test rocket, a thought came to mind...



Dark They Were and Golden Eyed (Full Text) by Ray Bradbury

This is the complete short story by Ray Bradbury. It is a story about change and adaptation. I first read this story in my teens and it influenced me to live the life that I am currently living. It is a great read.



A Sound of Thunder (Full Text) A Story by Ray Bradbury

This is the full text of the great time-travel story by Ray Bradbury. Here, a time-travel machine is used to send people back in time to shoot a dinosaur. However, something goes wrong. What would you do? It's a classic story and well worth a read again.



The April Witch (Full Text) by Ray Bradbury

This is a story written by Ray Bradbury that describes what might happen when a young teenaged girl has the power to enter the body of another person. What if, forbidden to experience love and relationships with "normal" people, she uses magic to experience forbidden pleasures...

Articles & Links

- You can start **reading the articles** by going [HERE](#).
- You can visit the Index Page [HERE](#) to explore by article subject.

- You can also ask the author some questions. You can go [HERE](#) to find out how to go about this.
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Notes

1. Began writing and composition 9AUG18.
2. Content completed 12AUG18.
3. SEO review 13 AUG18.
4. Publish 13AUG18.